05-23 第二篇

How Languages Change Over Time

Languages are not fixed—they grow and change like living things. The English we speak today is very different from the English of 500 years ago. New words appear, old words fade away, and grammar shifts slowly. [1] In fact, language change happens for many reasons: people move to new places and mix with others, technology brings new ideas and things to name, and young people often create new ways of speaking. That is why every language has a history. Studying how languages change helps us understand where we came from and how we communicate today.

What causes words to change? [2] Sometimes a word's meaning shifts—"nice" once meant "foolish" in old English, but now it means "kind" or "pleasant." New inventions need new words: "computer," "internet," and "smartphone" did not exist a century ago. Borrowing from other languages is common too—English has taken words from French, Latin, Greek, and many other languages. In other words, words change through use, invention, and contact with other cultures. The vocabulary of a language is always evolving（进化）.

Grammar also evolves. [3] Old English had more complex grammar, with many forms for different cases and genders. Over time, English became simpler—we dropped many endings and relied more on word order. Other languages change in different ways. For this reason, grammar is not a set of fixed rules—it reflects how people actually speak. What was "wrong" in the past may become standard in the future. Linguists（语言学家）study these changes to understand how our minds work with language.

Is language change good or bad? [4] Some people worry that languages are "declining" when they change. But change is natural—every living language has always changed. The question is not whether to stop change, but how to balance preserving tradition with allowing natural growth. It is true that we should value clear communication and good writing. At the same time, new words and expressions can make a language richer and more useful for new generations. So understanding language change helps us appreciate both the old and the new.

[5] In short, languages are always evolving, and that is part of their strength. They adapt to new needs, new technology, and new ways of life. Whether you prefer classic literature or modern slang（俚语）, you are part of this ongoing story. Remember: the way we speak today will sound different to people in 100 years—and that is okay. So the next time you hear a new word or phrase, think about it—you might be watching language history in the making.

选项

A. That is because languages change for many social and cultural reasons. B. In other words, vocabulary evolves through use, invention, and borrowing. C. That is why grammar reflects how people actually use language. D. It is true that we should balance tradition with natural language growth. E. In conclusion, language change is a natural and valuable part of language. F. For example, the word "selfie" was added to dictionaries in 2013.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：总领语言演变的原因。空前描述"Languages are not fixed—they grow and change like living things...The English we speak today is very different from the English of 500 years ago"，空后说明"In fact, language change happens for many reasons: people move to new places and mix with others, technology brings new ideas and things to name, and young people often create new ways of speaking...every language has a history"。A选项"That is because languages change for many social and cultural reasons"（那是因为语言因许多社会和文化原因而改变）中"That is because"解释语言演变，"many social and cultural reasons"与空后people move、technology、young people create new ways精准对应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：词汇演变的方式。空前设问"What causes words to change?"，空后列举"Sometimes a word's meaning shifts—'nice' once meant 'foolish'...New inventions need new words: 'computer,' 'internet,' 'smartphone'...Borrowing from other languages is common too—English has taken words from French, Latin, Greek...words change through use, invention, and contact with other cultures...The vocabulary of a language is always evolving"。B选项"In other words, vocabulary evolves through use, invention, and borrowing"（换言之，词汇通过使用、创造和借用而演变）中"In other words"概括空后内容，"use, invention, and borrowing"与空后meaning shifts、new inventions、borrowing完美呼应，衔接自然。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：语法的演变及其意义。空前提出"Grammar also evolves"，空后详述"Old English had more complex grammar...Over time, English became simpler—we dropped many endings and relied more on word order...grammar is not a set of fixed rules—it reflects how people actually speak...What was 'wrong' in the

past may become standard in the future...Linguists study these changes"。C选项"That is why grammar reflects how people actually use language"（因此语法反映人们实际如何使用语言）中"That is why"承接空前及空后结论，"reflects how people actually use"与空后reflects how people actually speak、fixed rules精准对应，逻辑紧密。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：如何看待语言变化——传统与创新的平衡。空前设问"Is language change good or bad?"，空后说明"Some people worry that languages are 'declining' when they change...But change is natural...The question is not whether to stop change, but how to balance preserving tradition with allowing natural growth...we should value clear communication and good writing...new words and expressions can make a language richer...understanding language change helps us appreciate both the old and the new"。D选项"It is true that we should balance tradition with natural language growth"（的确，我们应在传统与语言的天然发展之间取得平衡）中"It is true that"加强衔接，"balance tradition with natural growth"与空后balance preserving tradition with allowing natural growth完美呼应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与语言演变的价值。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"languages are always evolving, and that is part of their strength...They adapt to new needs, new technology, and new ways of life...you are part of this ongoing story...the way we speak today will sound different to people in 100 years—and that is okay...you might be watching language history in the making"。E选项"In conclusion, language change is a natural and valuable part of language"（总之，语言演变是语言自然且宝贵的一部分）用"In conclusion"总结全文，"natural and valuable part"与空后evolving、strength、adapt形成呼应，收束有力。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, the word "selfie" was added to dictionaries in 2013.**：涉及"selfie"入典的具体案例，易被误填[2]或[5]。但F属于单一词汇的举例，而空[2]综述词汇演变的多种途径（意义变化、新词创造、借用），空[5]强调语言演变的整体价值；F过于具体，与空[2]的概括性总结、空[5]的宏观收束论述层级不同。F属"主题相关但论述层级错位"型干扰。